

CMCA Flax Mill Caravan Park – Monthly Data Collation

Shire of Boyup Brook, Western Australia. Collated from confirmed and unconfirmed Ordinary Council Meeting Minutes. Period: June 2025 – April 2026 (May 2026 not yet available; OCM June 25, 2026). Compiled 19 June 2026.

Purpose

To document the month-by-month record of CMCA Caretaker reports and booking data for the Flax Mill Caravan Park, demonstrating that CMCA repeatedly documented demand for longer-term worker accommodation due to the housing crisis – prior to and alongside the introduction of the Short Term Stay Policy and eviction notices.

Revenue-sharing agreement: Shire receives 73% / CMCA retains 27% of gross income.

Note on sources: All data sourced directly from Shire of Boyup Brook council minutes. "% CMCA" figures refer to the percentage of income (not nights) from CMCA members unless otherwise stated. Site breakdown tables were not consistently included in all reports.

June 2025

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 31 July 2025. URL: <https://www.boyupbrook.wa.gov.au/documents/1403/council-minutes-31-july-2025>. Agenda Item: 9.4.4.

Total nights booked: 207. Gross income: \$5,747.00. Shire's share (73%): \$4,195.31. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: 47% CMCA members / 53% non-members. Year-on-year: revenue up 40% vs June 2024; gross income up 33% vs June 2024.

CMCA Caretaker report: Not included in this month's council report. [No reference to longer-term stays or housing shortage at this point.]

Bookings breakdown by site type: Not provided.

July 2025

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 25 September 2025. URL: <https://www.boyupbrook.wa.gov.au/documents/1424/council-minutes-25-september-2025>. Agenda Item: 9.4.5. Note: Reported two months late – the August 28, 2025 OCM did

not include a caravan park report (CEO and EMCS were both absent; no caravan park item on agenda).

Total nights booked: 219. Gross income: \$5,272.00. Shire's share (73%): \$3,848.56. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: 52% CMCA members / 48% non-members. Year-on-year: revenue up 34% vs July 2024; nights up 38%; gross income up 35%.

CMCA Caretaker report: Not included in this month's council report. [No reference to longer-term stays or housing shortage at this point.]

Bookings breakdown by site type: Not provided.

August 2025

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 25 September 2025. URL: <https://www.boyupbrook.wa.gov.au/documents/1424/council-minutes-25-september-2025>. Agenda Item: 9.4.6. Note: This is the **first** month the CMCA Caretaker quote about housing appeared.

Total nights booked: 213. Gross income: \$5,236.00. Shire's share (73%): \$3,822.28. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: 30% CMCA members / 70% non-members. Year-on-year: revenue down 10.5% vs August 2024; nights down 6%. Context: Report notes a "very wet and cold August" deterring eastern state travellers.

CMCA Caretaker report (direct quote):

The CMCA Caretaker reports that there are several patrons supporting the shearing industry and health industry who are seeking longer term accommodation due to the lack of available housing in Boyup Brook. There have also been several families staying overnight who are looking at properties to purchase to relocate to Boyup Brook. There are several caravan clubs who have bookings in the next month, and the wildflower season sees an influx of patrons to the caravan park.

Bookings breakdown by site type: Not provided.

September 2025

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 30 October 2025. URL: <https://www.boyupbrook.wa.gov.au/documents/1436/council-minutes-30-october-2025>. Agenda Item: 13.4.3.

Total nights booked: 391. Gross income: \$11,080.00. Shire's share (73%): \$8,088.40. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: 33% CMCA members / 67% non-members. Year-on-year: revenue up 29% vs September 2024; nights up 52%.

CMCA Caretaker report (direct quote):

There are continued bookings for several patrons supporting the shearing industry and health industry who are seeking longer term accommodation due to the lack of available housing in Boyup Brook. There are several caravan club bookings throughout October, with up to 23 sites reserved for each club visit. We expect to see a continued influx of visitors to Boyup Brook to enjoy the bountiful wildflower season and the upcoming Rodeo.

Bookings breakdown by site type:

Site type	Bookings
Self-Contained RVs (SCV)	8
SCV + Amenities Sites	76
Unpowered Van Sites	4
Powered Sites	218
Ensuite Sites	85
Total bookings	391

October 2025

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 27 November 2025. URL: <https://www.boyupbrook.wa.gov.au/documents/1443/council-minutes-27-november-2025>. Agenda Item: 9.4.3.

Total nights booked: 464. Gross income: \$12,296.00. Shire's share (73%): \$8,976.08. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: Not stated in report. Year-on-year: revenue up 29% vs October 2024; nights up 47%. Context: Report notes this increase is "in line with last month's increase."

CMCA Caretaker report (direct quote):

There continues to be demand for accommodation for patrons supporting the shearing industry and health industry who are seeking longer term accommodation due to the lack of available housing in Boyup Brook. With the warmer weather approaching and the grounds freshly mowed, the addition of the new site type, 'Unpowered River Site', to the CMCA booking page has been well received. The partly shaded areas along the Blackwood River offer a peaceful retreat for visitors, with bookings for these sites far exceeding those for the standard unpowered sites this month.

Bookings breakdown by site type:

Site type	Bookings
Self-Contained RVs (SCV)	39
SCV + Amenities Sites	90
Unpowered Van Sites	2
Unpowered River Sites	20
Powered Sites	254
Ensuite Sites	59
Total bookings	464

November 2025

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 29 January 2026. Location: Council-Minutes-29-January-2026.pdf (CMCA folder). Agenda Item: 10.4.3 (combined November and December 2025 report).

Total nights booked: 328. Gross income: \$8,562.00. Shire's share (73%): \$6,250.26. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: 33% CMCA members / 67% non-members. Year-on-year: revenue down 24% vs November 2024; nights down 19%.

CMCA Caretaker report (direct quote):

There continues to be demand for accommodation for patrons supporting the shearing industry and health industry who are seeking longer term accommodation due to the lack of available housing in Boyup Brook.

Additional: 67% of bookings were non-CMCA members and 33% were CMCA members.

Bookings breakdown by site type:

Site type	Bookings
Self-Contained RVs (SCV)	25
SCV + Amenities Sites	71
Unpowered Van Sites	0
Unpowered River Sites	9
Powered Sites	170
Ensuite Sites	53
Total bookings	328

December 2025

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 29 January 2026. Location: Council-Minutes-29-January-2026.pdf. Agenda Item: 10.4.3 (combined November and December 2025 report).

Total nights booked: 476. Gross income: \$10,838.00. Shire's share (73%): \$7,911.74. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: 43% CMCA members / 57% non-members. Year-on-year: revenue down ~9% vs December 2024; nights up 15%. Context: Report notes total nights increased but income fell due to shift in booking mix – fewer ensuite sites, more unpowered and SCV bookings.

CMCA Caretaker report (direct quote):

There continues to be demand for longer term accommodation from patrons supporting the shearing and health industries, largely due to the ongoing shortage of available housing in Boyup Brook. There is a steady increase in the number of individual travellers and families choosing to stay at the Flax Mill Caravan Park during the festive season, attracted by the peaceful setting along the Blackwood River.

Additional: 57% non-CMCA / 43% CMCA members.

Bookings breakdown by site type:

Site type	Bookings
Self-Contained RVs (SCV)	151
SCV + Amenities Sites	8
Unpowered Van Sites	0
Unpowered River Sites	45
Powered Sites	230
Ensuite Sites	42
Total bookings	476

January 2026

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 26 February 2026. Location: Council-Minutes-26-February-2026.pdf (CMCA folder). Agenda Item: 10.4.3.

Total nights booked: 544. Gross income: \$13,340.00. Shire's share (73%): \$9,738.20. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: 45% CMCA members / 55% non-members. Year-on-year: revenue up 18% vs January 2025; nights up 39%. Context: Lower revenue increase relative to nights reflects booking mix shift – 43% increase in SCV (lower nightly fee) and 25% increase in new Unpowered River sites.

CMCA Caretaker report (key points – multiple dot points in original):

There continues to be a steady increase in individual travellers and families choosing to stay at the Flax Mill Caravan Park during the school holiday period, attracted by the peaceful setting along the Blackwood River.

Demand for longer term accommodation continues to grow, with a significant increase in requests for permanent residency being received.

Current long-term residents generally utilise the caravan park to support the shearing and health industries, with some others residing due to lack of affordable housing in the region. There has been a notable increase in requests from outlying regions, including metropolitan areas, driven by ongoing housing shortages and affordability.

With the increase in long term residents, concerns have been raised that the Caravan Park may be unintentionally attracting patrons seeking permanent residency.

CMCA management have been working with the Shire to assess the current situation and options for managing this into the future. As the Shire holds the licence for the Caravan Park, there are legislative restrictions that must be complied with.

It is recommended that the Shire and CMCA re-assess the maximum stay period at the CMCA Flax Mill Caravan Park to establish guidelines that are compliant, balanced, and that continue to support those requiring shorter term accommodation, without adversely impacting tourism.

Bookings breakdown by site type: Table not extractable from PDF (formatted table).
Note: Report references 43% increase in SCV and 25% increase in Unpowered River sites.

February 2026

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 26 March 2026. Location: Council-Minutes-26-March-2026.pdf (CMCA folder). Agenda Item: 10.4.1.

Total nights booked: 782. Gross income: \$20,370.00. Shire's share (73%): \$14,870.10. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: 31% CMCA members / 69% non-members. Year-on-year: revenue up 1.45% vs February 2025; nights up 4%. Context: 218 nights booked during Country Music Festival period (down 14% on previous year's festival period). Revenue increase modest due to 151% increase in SCV bookings (lower fee) and 100% decrease in SCV + Amenities bookings. Community economic impact: extrapolated voluntary receipt survey = \$50,544 local spend.

CMCA Caretaker report (key points – multiple dot points in original):

Demand for longer term accommodation remains consistent, with a notable increase in requests for extended or permanent residency.

Current long-term residents utilise the caravan park to support industries such as shearing and health services, while some residents are residing at the park due to the continued lack of affordable housing within the region.

There has also been an increase in patrons seeking long term accommodation of two to three months associated with infrastructure and project works, e.g. road works, Water Corporation projects, and a recent enquiry from a mineral resource exploration company seeking accommodation for several staff for approximately three months.

CMCA management and the Park Custodian, in conjunction with the Shire, will continue to monitor long-term stays at the CMCA Flax Mill Caravan Park until the statutory review [of the Residential Parks (Long-stay Tenants) Act 2006] is completed and further guidance becomes available.

The current approach is to limit stays to two months, with any extension to the stay to be considered on a case-by-case basis. The review is carried out and approval provided by CMCA and the Shire, with a priority for critical workers and patrons with employment or project works within the Shire.

Bookings breakdown by site type: Table not extractable from PDF (formatted table).

March 2026

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 30 April 2026. Location: Council-Minutes-30-April-2026.pdf (CMCA folder). Agenda Item: 10.4.1.

Total nights booked: 488. Gross income: \$13,617.00. Shire's share (73%): \$9,940.41. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: Not stated in report. Year-on-year: revenue up 41% vs March 2025; nights up 41% (up 142 nights). Context: Early March long weekend contributed to demand; strong demand for unpowered river sites and ensuite sites; waterwise plumbing upgrades completed (\$25,060 funded by Water Corporation).

CMCA Caretaker report (key points – multiple dot points in original):

Demand for longer term accommodation has gained momentum again, with a notable increase in requests for extended residency.

Long term residency requests are primarily associated with essential workers and individuals engaged in local industries such as shearing, infrastructure projects, road works, and health services. In some instances, longer stays are also being sought due to the limited availability of affordable housing within the region.

While the increase in longer term occupancy supports workforce accommodation needs, it also presents a risk that the Caravan Park may be perceived as accommodating longer term or semi-permanent residency. This is being actively monitored.

The Shire and CMCA are awaiting the outcome of the [LGIRS] statutory review of the Residential Parks (Long-stay Tenants) Act 2006.

Bookings breakdown by site type: Table not extractable from PDF (formatted table).

April 2026

Source: Minutes – Ordinary Council Meeting 28 May 2026 (UNCONFIRMED). Location: Council-Minutes-28-May-2026-(unconfirmed).pdf (CMCA folder). Agenda Item: 10.4.1. Note: These are unconfirmed minutes – not yet ratified by Council. Note: The following agenda item (10.4.2) introduced the Short Term Stay Policy.

Total nights booked: 589. Gross income: \$15,484.00. Shire's share (73%): \$11,344.00. Additional adjustment: \$2,439.66 CMCA adjustment relating to February and March 2026. CMCA vs. non-CMCA income: Not stated in report. Year-on-year: revenue up 36.5% vs April 2025; nights up 23% (up 112 nights). Context: "Occupancy largely driven by longer stay visitors." Cooler autumn weather and "continuing trend toward extended stays."

CMCA Caretaker report (key points – multiple dot points in original):

Demand for longer term accommodation has remained consistent over the past month, with continued requests for extended residency.

Requests for longer stays are primarily associated with essential workers and individuals engaged in local industries such as shearing, infrastructure projects, road works and health services. Increasingly, extended stays are also being sought due to the limited availability of affordable housing within the region.

While the increase in longer term occupancy assists in meeting workforce accommodation needs, it also presents a risk that the Caravan Park may be perceived as facilitating longer term or semi-permanent residency. This is being actively monitored.

Both parties have also considered the potential implementation of stricter short stay limits. This strategy is presented to Council for consideration in a separate item within this Agenda. [i.e. Item 10.4.2 – the Short Term Stay Policy]

Bookings breakdown by site type:

Site type	Bookings
Self-Contained RVs (SCV)	148
SCV + Amenities Sites	0
Unpowered Van Sites	7
Unpowered River Sites	104
Powered Sites	234
Ensuite Sites	96
CMF Overflow Sites	0
Total bookings	589

May 2026

Not yet available. The Ordinary Council Meeting at which May 2026 data would be reported is scheduled for 25 June 2026. This document will need to be sourced after that meeting.

Summary table

Month	Nights	Gross Income	Shire Share	CMC A%	Housing/Workforce Reference in Caretaker Report
Jun 2025	207	\$5,747.00	\$4,195.31	47%	No
Jul 2025	219	\$5,272.00	\$3,848.56	52%	No
Aug 2025	213	\$5,236.00	\$3,822.28	30%	YES – first appearance
Sep 2025	391	\$11,080.00	\$8,088.40	33%	YES
Oct 2025	464	\$12,296.00	\$8,976.08	N/S	YES
Nov 2025	328	\$8,562.00	\$6,250.26	33%	YES
Dec 2025	476	\$10,838.00	\$7,911.74	43%	YES
Jan 2026	544	\$13,340.00	\$9,738.20	45%	YES – escalating: "significant increase in requests for permanent residency"
Feb 2026	782	\$20,370.00	\$14,870.10	31%	YES – workforce demand plus infrastructure workers
Mar 2026	488	\$13,617.00	\$9,940.41	N/S	YES – "momentum again"
Apr 2026	589	\$15,484.00	\$11,344.00	N/S	YES – also: Short Term Stay Policy introduced same meeting
May 2026	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	Pending (OCM June 25, 2026)

N/S = Not stated in report.

Total nights booked June 2025 – April 2026: 4,701. Total gross income June 2025 – April 2026: \$122,319.00. Total Shire share June 2025 – April 2026: approximately \$89,293.00.

Key analytical observations

1. The CMCA Caretaker first documented housing-shortage-related demand in August 2025. This continued in every single monthly report from that point through to April 2026 – nine consecutive months before eviction notices were issued.
2. The January 2026 report marks an escalation: CMCA reported "significant increase in requests for permanent residency" and noted "increase in requests from outlying regions, including metropolitan areas, driven by ongoing housing shortages." Critically, CMCA recommended reassessing the maximum stay period – not eviction.
3. The February 2026 report documented demand not just from shearing and health industries but from infrastructure workers (road works, Water Corporation, mineral exploration). The 2-month limit with case-by-case extension was explicitly described as the policy at that time – not a blanket eviction policy.
4. The April 2026 report was the last before the Short Term Stay Policy (eviction notices) was introduced as Item 10.4.2 at the same meeting. The caretaker's own report in that same agenda did not call for evictions – it called for "actively monitoring" the situation.
5. The park generated \$122,319 in gross income over 11 months (June 2025 – April 2026), of which the Shire received approximately \$89,293. Longer-term stays contributed materially to this revenue. The Short Term Stay Policy risks reducing this income.

Sources

- Jun 2025: <https://www.boyupbrook.wa.gov.au/documents/1403/council-minutes-31-july-2025>
- Jul 2025: <https://www.boyupbrook.wa.gov.au/documents/1424/council-minutes-25-september-2025>
- Aug 2025: <https://www.boyupbrook.wa.gov.au/documents/1424/council-minutes-25-september-2025>
- Sep 2025: <https://www.boyupbrook.wa.gov.au/documents/1436/council-minutes-30-october-2025>
- Oct 2025: <https://www.boyupbrook.wa.gov.au/documents/1443/council-minutes-27-november-2025>

- Nov 2025: Council-Minutes-29-January-2026.pdf (CMCA folder, Shire of Boyup Brook website)
- Dec 2025: Council-Minutes-29-January-2026.pdf (CMCA folder, Shire of Boyup Brook website)
- Jan 2026: Council-Minutes-26-February-2026.pdf (CMCA folder, Shire of Boyup Brook website)
- Feb 2026: Council-Minutes-26-March-2026.pdf (CMCA folder, Shire of Boyup Brook website)
- Mar 2026: Council-Minutes-30-April-2026.pdf (CMCA folder, Shire of Boyup Brook website)
- Apr 2026: Council-Minutes-28-May-2026-(unconfirmed).pdf (CMCA folder, unconfirmed minutes)